

Core unlocking in Windows

MSI allows users on their latest boards to unlock cores on locked processors from Windows

65k Androids daily

Google predicts 65,000 Android devices are being sold daily

can be added to make playlists. Audio effects work fairly with the comfortable bundled headphones. Google maps works smoothly and MotoNav's extensive location database is a help in locating hotels or restaurants.

But it's not the bundled apps that Android is about. Enter the Android Market and let the shopping begin! They are downloaded and installed much quicker than what Apple app store does. Although people point out that the lack of restrictions is the reason that Android market is thriving. But it's more about the customizability that Android offers. Everything from the on screen keyboard to the dialer can be changed. File explorers and media players get uninhibited access to file system. Android developers are breaking free whereas the Apple developers are encountering walls.

Verdict

Let's admit it. Apple's iPhone is still the phone to beat. But for all those who are looking for something different (or something for the future, as we put it), Milestone is by far the best option. A year back, the AppStore was termed as the 'fab thing that will keep iPhone up there', but now it's the flabby, slow moving thing that may eventually pull Apple's mighty phone down. The restriction free Android market was touted to be the USP of Google's free-for-all operating system, and it has lived up to its reputation. The Milestone was one last throw of dice for Motorola, and what a throw it has been!

Apple iPhone 3GS

Having kept an Apple iPhone 3G and 3GS side by side, it was

impossible to tell the difference between the two. Such is the physical resemblance between the two versions.

The technical sheet says the processor has been upgraded from 412 MHz to 600 Mhz. The RAM has been doubled from 128 MB to 256 MB and 3GS has HSPDA running at 7.2 Mbps compared to 3.6 in the 3G. The camera is 3.0MP with autofocus, which actually works well! The battery life is said to be improved but in real tests, we found a significant difference only in 2G operation. The screen has the same resolution (480x320) but has a new oleophobic coating which is a relief, compared to the old smudge-loving iPhone screen. Although newer phones like Google Nexus One have faster processors, the operation of iPhone 3GS is slick and smooth with no jitters even after we loaded five homescreens' worth of apps.

The OS 3.0 has a number of new tricks as well. The copy-paste feature for instance allows you to copy anything, like text and pictures, from anywhere and paste it wherever the holy blinking cursor exists. You can pick up text and images from web pages and paste them in your email or pick up the content of your email and SMS it to someone. The process is smooth with two end pointers that can be dragged to include the selections.

Video recording finally comes to iPhone as its 3MP camera records VGA quality videos at 30fps. But again Apple has topped this late cake with a cherry. You can edit the videos on the phone itself. However, the process of editing is destructive, i.e. you either keep the original

or the cropped, once edited, the old copy is lost. Although VGA might be considered ancient compared to the near HD quality recording most phones are offering today, the camcorder of iPhone 3GS does its job fairly well.

Although iPhone 3GS allows push notifications (applications can send pop-ups or other alerts), its nowhere close to real multitasking, something that 3GS is well capable of (and would be doing this summer onwards!). Voice Control allows you to control



Apple iPhone 3GS

your music, make calls and do other little stuff like asking, "What track is playing?". A2DP comes to the rescue of those holding onto their Bluetooth music headphones for long and it works smoothly.

Verdict

Though the Android 2.1 OS might have pushed the 3GS down the pecking order, it is still debatable whether the release of Apple OS 4.0 will see it fighting back or withering down. Still, for its awesome app collection in AppStore, its excellent display, and its

unbelievable touchscreen, the iPhone 3GS is a top-top phone.

Sony Ericsson Satio

SE Satio is Sony Ericsson's mighty knight in the battle of megapixels. It's 12.1MP is one of the best cameras in the market and the only camera we tested with a Xenon flash, that does a good job in low-light conditions. It has an OS and feature set very similar to Vivaz. The single LED flash, as compared to Vivaz's double, is also a turn off. But strangely, the operation of Satio is smoother than the Vivaz as the Symbian S60 5th Edition does a better job in Satio, and we like most of it, except the part where you need to click twice on menu options, once to highlight, then to open. But, Satio does not have the Apps bundled with the Vivaz.

Satio has an elegant Piano black body, with rounded upper and lower ends, and straight metallic sides housing a plethora of buttons including a dedicated camera button, 'camera-camcorder mode toggle' button, volume rocker that doubles up as 'zoom' control, and a 'Media Gallery' button on the right panel. While the left side-panel houses the charging port, microSD card slot, and a 'key-lock' button. However the form factor is on the larger side, with the body getting particularly thick in the upper part housing the mega-camera lens and the huge lens cover.

The camera does a good job. We might have liked warmer tones, but it is still the best camera as far as still pictures are considered. However, the video recording is average. The video playback was nearly as good as the Vivaz, and running close on heels of the winner of "Best Video Playback" award is